



It is not the world class infrastructure or the state of the art wireless VPN connectivity between the campuses but the Quality that has made KIIT a class of its own. NMC and MBA accreditation to KIIT by the UGC and the AICTE, two apex bodies created by Acts of Parliament to approve, regulate the standard of any institution of higher studies and technical education, speak it all. To endorse the standard, the ranking by several independent bodies **ranked KIIT as 16th** amongst all the technical institutions of the country and **5th among the self-financing universities**. Mention of KIIT in two Limca Book for Records are definitely the icing on the cake.

A university is known by the programmes it runs, the faculty members and its associations. Roping distinguished academicians culled from IITs, NITs, JIMs and abroad to train the students from Engineering, Management Rural Management, Law, Biotechnology, MCA, Medical Science and Dental Science is by no means a mean achievement. The national and international seminars organized in KIIT have set new standards in the academic circles and the convergence of best brains including Nobel Laureates illustrate the standard and standing of the university. Over six hundred research publications by the faculties in KIIT stand as a testimony to KIIT's excellence.

In the present world scenario, collaboration definitely holds key to success. KIIT's collaboration with industries, world universities and membership of prestigious international bodies make the institution unique. Being the member of Association of Commonwealth Universities (ACU), University Mobility in Asia and the Pacific (UMAP), and being a signatory to the MoUs signed with over **25 leading universities of the world**, KIIT has successfully opened the floodgates for its students and the students of the hundred of universities of the world to numerous exchange programmes including studying and researching in each others universities.

Academics without employment can be frustrating for the students coming out from the universities. KIIT remains an exception where students are assured of their employment before passing out their final examinations. Hundred percent placements for its students even during the recession is incredible indeed by any standard.

Creation of a world class university never satisfied Samanta whose heart was breeding for the underprivileged Poverty stricken tribal children of the country.

His interface with hunger, poverty remained the inspiring force within to give the poorest of the poor a decent life. The finest expression of his social commitment is best illustrated in Kalinga Institute of Social Science--- (KISS) the largest institution in South Asia exclusively for ten thousand tribal

children. The poorest of the poor tribal children are provided here with food, accommodation, healthcare and all other basic necessities of life to pursue their studies from Kindergarten to Post Graduation (KG to PG). It has been hailed as **another Santiniketan**. Given the scope tribal children can excel in every field, a fact that has been proved by the children of KISS who have been bringing laurels for the country through their performances in Academics and Sports.

Samanta's conviction that 'Poverty creates illiteracy and literacy drives poverty away' and the guru mantra that 'Giving education is like giving sight to a visually impaired person' have become so very relevant that everyone starting from the President of the country down to the Vice President, Nobel Laureates, Governors, Cabinet Ministers, State Chief Ministers, Parliamentarians, Industrialists, Social workers, Scientists, Diplomats and even the Premier of North-west Province of South Africa who visited KIIT and KISS were unanimous that while KISS needs to be replicated in every nook and corner of the world, the former should serve as a role model for every academic institution aspiring to excel. With awe everyone exclaimed with astonishment as to how such a great institution like KIIT could brace itself amongst the world class centers of excellence within the shortest possible time despite the poverty-stricken background of its architect Achyuta Samanta who proved to be another Madan Mohan Malaviya when he founded KIIT without even a penny in his pocket. Even the former HRD minister Arjun Singh during his visit eulogized Samanta as la Malaviya.

Great men do not do different things but they do things differently, perhaps sums up the character of Samanta the man who being born poor has been making the world rich through his vision, social entrepreneurship and conviction. Rewards keep coming in shape of recognition and accolades from all quarters to Samanta who still remains in a rented house with all his humility, unmindful of what the world thinks of him for the work he is doing for humanity.

India needs more Samantas, said APJ Abdul Kalam, a view echoed by Kiran Bedi when she said she found the real 'Bharat Ratna' in him. 'It is indeed rare to find any individual sacrificing his personal comfort to make the world a better place to live in. This has been observed by most of the distinguished personalities visiting KISS and KIIT. But like all visionaries, Samanta looks above, indicating all these have happened only by the blessings of God. A passion driven Samanta has many more plans up to his sleeves and he still has glitters in his eyes that defy sleep, for he has to go miles before he sleeps.